

# THE EXTERIOR

When TWA Fokker F10A NC999E crashed in March 1931, accident investigators called for regular (and expensive) checks on wooden-sparred airplanes. In response, Boeing created the all-metal Model 247, but was contractually obliged to provide 60 of the new aircraft to affiliated United Airlines before delivering others to competitors. Douglas leapt into the breach, creating the DC-2 for TWA. The type became one of the first all-metal airliners. The airframe would pave the way for the later DC-3 (designated C-47 in military service) of which more than 10,000 were built.

1. Twin landing lights in the nose 2. Modern retrofitted radio aerials allow communication with the ground for navigation and weather checking 3. Riveted aluminum skins were strong and easy to repair 4. Fuel drains 5. Aerodynamic handles and fairing helped increase cruise speed 6. Main cabin door 7. Wright Cyclone engines drove three-bladed propellers and were housed in streamlined cowlings 8. Exhaust port 9. Oil cooler 10. Cabin windows for 14 passengers 11. Aileron balance horn 12. Vertical tail fin (with race number from MacRobertson Trophy Air Race) 13. Tail lights

